

VENOM

The costume makes the villain



The symbiote flowed over Eddie Brock, viewing the suicidal journalist as a kindred spirit.

While SPIDER-MAN was on the BEYONDER's "Battleworld," he acquired a black costume, which turned out to be an alien being that bonded itself to him. Spider-Man rejected this alien symbiote, which then latched onto an ex-*Daily Globe* columnist Eddie Brock, transforming him into Venom.

THE ORIGINAL VENOM

A disgraced ex-reporter, Brock blamed Spider-Man for ruining his career by revealing Brock's error in identifying the wrong man as the Sin-Eater. Stricken with cancer, he was about to kill himself when the symbiote bonded with him and

put his disease into remission. Angry at Spider-Man for spurning it, the symbiote urged Brock to take his revenge on Spider-Man, and the bonded pair set out to do just that. Armed with the knowledge of Spider-Man's secret identity—and being hidden from Spider-Man's spider-sense—Brock became one of his most dangerous foes. At times, however, the two declared a truce, and during such periods Brock sometimes worked as an antihero, killing those who would threaten innocents.

VENOM'S OFFSPRING

The Venom symbiote has reproduced a number of times, its children finding hosts of their own. This included Scream, CARNAGE and his spawn Toxin, plus Riot, Phage, Lasher, and Agony, who later combined to form Hybrid. When Brock's cancer returned, the symbiote wanted to leave him. Brock auctioned the creature off for \$100 million dollars from gang lord Don Fortunato, who gave the suit to his son Angelo. Disgusted by Angelo's cowardice, the suit abandoned him in mid-air to die.



When Gargan attacked Brock, Brock turned into Anti-Venom.

ENTER THE SCORPION

The symbiote offered itself to Mac Gargan (the SCORPION), who eagerly accepted the creature's incredible powers. After a failed attempt to defeat Spider-Man with the Sinister Twelve, Gargan joined the THUNDERBOLTS during the CIVIL WAR (see pp. 84-5), helping them track down superpowered outlaws who refused to register with the US government.

With Gargan as its host, Venom becomes more violent and monstrous than ever, actually devouring some of his victims. When Gargan attacked Brock, however, the symbiote tried to return to Brock. Instead, Brock turned into ANTI-VENOM and nearly killed Gargan.

Gargan recovered and fought the SKRULLS during the SECRET INVASION (see pp. 326-7). Afterward, Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN) transferred Gargan from the Thunderbolts to his new AVENGERS. Administering a medicine that made the symbiote seem less monstrous again—at least temporarily—Osborn then had Gargan pose as Spider-Man on the new team. **MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *Amazing Spider-Man* #299-300

The first appearance of Eddie Brock as Venom.

• *Marvel Knights: Spider-Man*

#7-8 Brock auctions off the Venom symbiote to Angelo Fortunato for \$100 million.

• *Marvel Knights: Spider-Man*

#9-12 Mac Gargan becomes the new Venom.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

MacDonald "Mac" Gargan

OCCUPATION

Assassin-for-hire,

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

6 ft 2 in

WEIGHT

220 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

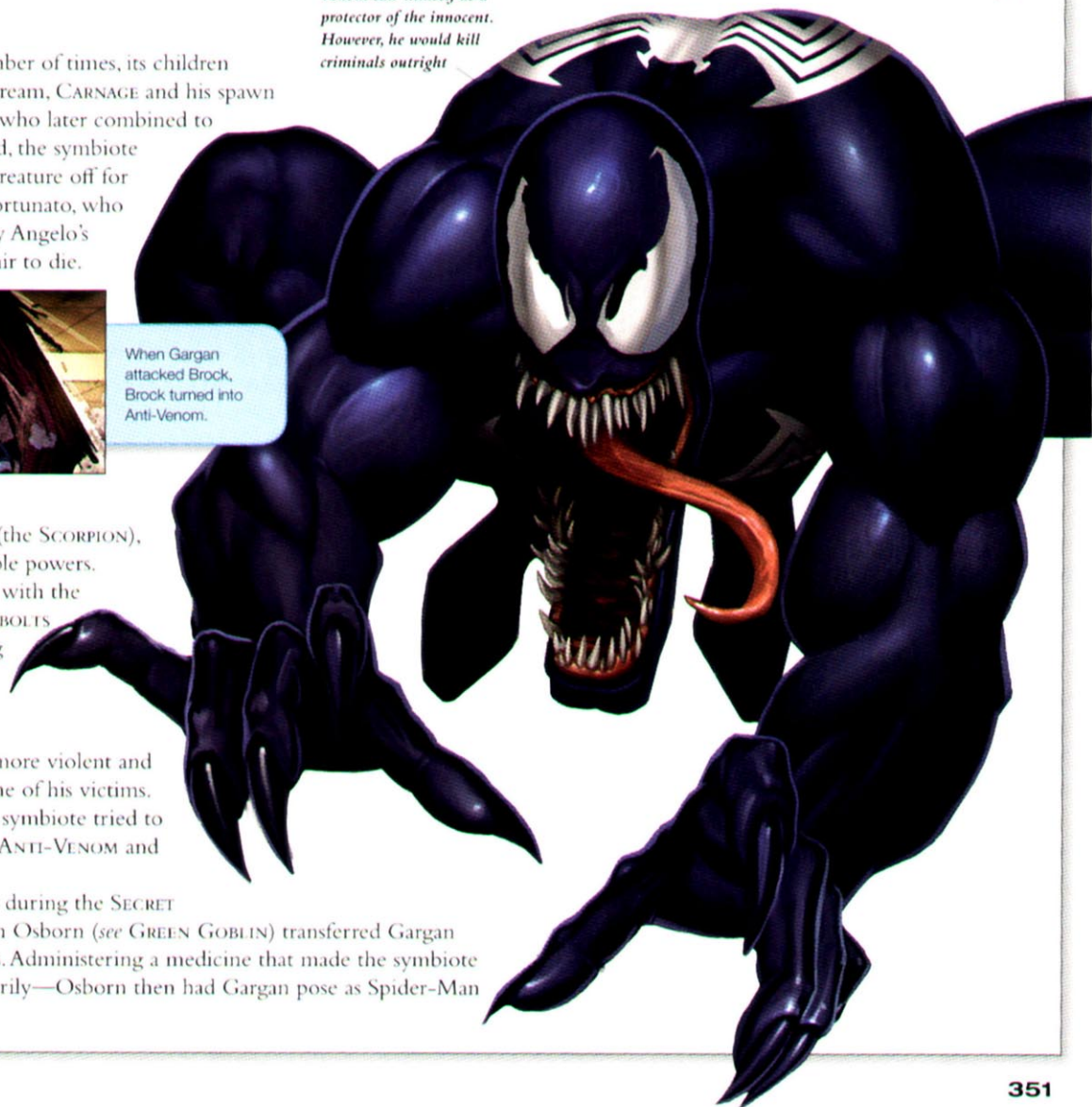
Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

The Amazing Spider-Man #298 (March 1988)

Venom possesses superhuman strength, speed, and agility. Like Spider-Man, his hands and feet can adhere to most surfaces. Can project web-like substance from his "costume."

Venom saw himself as a protector of the innocent. However, he would kill criminals outright



VENOM

POWERS